



Baseline

Getting started

Baseline decides what you should train **today** — from how recovered you are and what you have actually been doing. Not a plan written weeks ago. A decision made this morning.

This guide takes about five minutes to read. You only need it once.

Everything in the app stays on your own phone.
No account, no sign-up, nothing uploaded anywhere.

WHAT IT IS

One session a day, and the reason for it

Most training apps hand you a calendar decided in advance: legs on Tuesday, whether or not you slept badly, played a match on Monday, or feel like you have been hit by a bus.

Baseline asks you a few questions each morning, then gives you **one session** — and tells you why it chose that one and what it ruled out. If you disagree, you change it, and it adapts around what you actually did.

What it needs from you

- About a minute each morning
- A tap when you finish a session
- Anything else you do, logged in three taps

What it does not need

- An account or a password
- A gym, or any equipment at all
- A watch or fitness tracker
- An internet connection, after the first load

A day in the app

1 Open it and check in.

How long you slept, four sliders for how you feel, whether anything hurts, and how long you have. The sliders start where you left them, so most days are a nudge or two.

2 Read today's session.

A name, a duration, an intensity. Nothing else competes with it on the screen.

3 Tap “Why this?” if you want the reasoning

— what counted, and what it decided against.

4 Start it.

The screen becomes the workout: one exercise at a time, what you lifted last time, and plus/minus buttons instead of a keyboard.

5 Tell it how that felt

— one tap at the end. This is the single thing that most changes what you get next time.

6 Log anything else.

A match, a walk, helping a friend move house. Unplanned activity is not a missed workout.

Nothing is assumed about you. No sport, no equipment, no goal, no tracker, no injuries — every one of those starts empty, and empty is a perfectly good answer. Tick nothing at all and you still get a complete bodyweight programme.

STEP 1 OF 2

Put it on your Home Screen — iPhone & iPad

Baseline is a website that behaves like an app. Adding it to your Home Screen gives it its own icon, makes it open full-screen without the browser bars, and — importantly — tells iPhone to keep your data.

You must use Safari for this

Chrome and other browsers on iPhone cannot add a working app to the Home Screen. If you opened the link somewhere else, copy it into Safari first.

1 Open the link in Safari.

Tap the link you were sent. Wait for it to finish loading.

2 Tap the Share button.

It is the square with an arrow pointing up, at the bottom of the screen (or the top right on an iPad).

3 Scroll down and tap “Add to Home Screen”.

It is a fair way down the list, past the sharing options.

4 Tap “Add”

at the top right. The icon appears on your Home Screen.

5 Open it from that icon from now on

— not from Safari.



This is the icon you are looking for.

It will be named **Baseline**. You can rename it while adding it if you would rather call it something else.

This matters more than it looks. Left as an ordinary Safari tab, iPhone may delete the app's saved data after about a week of you not opening it. Added to the Home Screen, it is treated as a real app and kept.

STEP 1 OF 2

...and on Android

1 Open the link in Chrome.

2 Tap the three-dot menu

at the top right.

3 Tap “Install app”

, or “Add to Home screen” if that is what yours says.

4 Confirm with “Install”

or “Add”.

On a laptop it works too: in Chrome or Edge there is a small install icon at the right-hand end of the address bar. On a Mac, Safari has **File → Add to Dock**.

Does the installed version share my data with the browser tab?

Yes, as long as the web address is identical. They are the same app. It is still worth using the icon, for the reason above.

The first two minutes

The first time you open it, Baseline asks seven short questions. Every one of them can be skipped or left empty — the button says **Skip** when there is nothing to save, so you are never guessing whether an answer is required.

IT ASKS	WHY
Your name	So it can say good morning. Nothing else.
What you are training for	Shifts the balance between strength, conditioning and physique work.
Your sport	Shapes your warm-ups and priorities. It is never scheduled — you log it when you play. Leave it empty if you do not play one.
Where you train	At a gym and everything is assumed available — you only say what yours is missing. At home and nothing is assumed — you tick what you have. You are only ever shown exercises you can actually do.
How much you can train	Days a week, and how long a session usually is.
A tracker OPTIONAL	WHOOP, Garmin, Oura, Fitbit, Apple Watch and others. The app works completely without one.
Age, height, weight OPTIONAL	Context only. It does not change your programme.

Close it half way through and nothing is lost. It reopens exactly where you left off, with what you had already entered.

Then you land on Today

A short walkthrough appears once, explaining how the app works. You can skip it, and reopen it any time from **Settings** → **About** → **How Baseline works**.

THE MAIN SCREEN

Today

This is the screen you will use nearly every time you open the app. It answers four questions in order: how am I doing, what should I do, why, and what do I do next.

Three scores

Drawn as open arcs, the shape of the app's own mark. **Readiness** leads — out of 100, with its band in words. **Strain** (out of 21) and **Sleep** sit below it, because they are the context for it rather than its equals. Each one opens the screen that explains it. An arc with nothing behind it shows a dash rather than a zero.

Today's session

The name, roughly how long, and how hard. One **Start session** button, deliberately the most prominent thing on the screen.

Why this?

Tap to expand. Lists what counted towards the decision, and what it ruled out and why — “Intervals: tennis yesterday already loaded the legs.”

Change today's plan

Always available. Shows every option ranked by today's data. Overriding is recorded and adapted to, never held against you.

This week

Seven days with what you did on each, the small number being your **readiness** that day. Arrows move between weeks — there is no forward arrow on the current week, because there is nothing there yet.

Today's activities

The day drawn down a spine: each effort with the strain it came to and a bar as long as it ran, against the longest thing you did. Two buttons at the foot — **Add activity** and **Start activity**.

Good morning, Sam

Friday 18 September

74 Readiness
Ready · out of 100

8.2
Strain

7.4h
Sleep

Today
Lower A
~50 min · Moderate

Start session

Why this?

THIS WEEK

< M T W T F S S

TODAY'S ACTIVITIES

07:00 • Cycling 40m 4.4
18:00 • Tennis 1h 30m 8.2

+ Add

Start

Today Train Progress Settings

The check-in

Tap **Check in** and answer: how long you slept (one slider), four more for **energy, soreness, stress and motivation**, whether anything **hurts**, and **how long you have** today. The sliders start where you left them, so an unchanged day is a nudge or two.

ANSWER	WHAT IT DOES
Sleep	Adjustable to the minute. Pre-filled from your tracker where your import covers the date.
Four sliders	Weighted into your readiness score alongside everything else.

Pain	The one answer that is not a weighting. Anything beyond mild caps what the app will suggest, whatever the rest of the numbers say.
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Time to train	Trims the session to fit rather than handing you something you cannot finish.
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If you wear a tracker and your imported export covers today, its recovery, HRV and resting heart rate are filled in for you and shown as read-only. If you have not imported anything covering today, it asks you for those numbers instead — and you can leave them blank.

Leave anything blank and the app simply weighs it out. It will never invent a number you did not give it.

The workout screen

Tap **Start session** and the app changes: the navigation disappears and you get **one set at a time** in a single large card, with the sets you have not reached yet not drawn at all — they are not decisions you are making now.

ON SCREEN	WHAT IT DOES
Set 2 of 4	And what comes next, by name: <i>"Next: Bench Press · set 1 of 3"</i> . You always know how close the end is.
The plan, in words	<i>"hard, with about 3 reps left in you · about a minute between sets"</i> rather than RPE and tempo notation. The exact figures are under More.
One line of how	What the exercise actually is, with the full instructions a tap away.
Last time	What you did the last time — the number you are trying to beat — and why today's target is what it is.
Reps and kg	Plus and minus — no keyboard. Steps match your equipment. No kg field on an exercise that cannot carry any.
Log set	One button. Rest counts down inside the card you just finished, not in a bar at the bottom of the screen.
A hold	A plank or a carry gets a countdown, not a rep count — and it logs itself when the hold finishes.
Logged	Finished sets shrink to a row of chips. Tap one to take it back.
More	How to do it · Why this exercise · Replace it · This hurt · Add a note · Skip it

Finishing an exercise moves you on by itself — after four seconds, counted on screen, and cancelled the moment you touch anything. Reaching for the undo chip is itself a reason not to move on.

"This hurt"

One tap. That exercise is left out of your sessions for three weeks and something covering the same movement is swapped in immediately, so you can carry on. Sharp or lasting pain is worth a word with a physio or doctor rather than only an app setting.

At the end

A summary, and one question: **Too easy · About right · Too hard**. It is a single tap and it is the most useful thing you can tell the app — after three sessions rated the same way, it starts adjusting how much work it gives you.

Stop half way through and nothing is lost. The exit button always asks, and **Pause** keeps everything exactly as it is — Today offers the session back when you return.

Three more sections

Train

Opens with this week's targets and where you are in the eight-week progression. Underneath: your workouts, the exercise library filtered to your equipment, warm-ups, and every session you have finished.

Progression is **earned, not scheduled**. Miss a fortnight and the plan waits for you rather than marching on to a peak week you have not worked for.

Progress

Opens with how your week actually went. Then, one tap each: whether individual lifts are moving, fitness test results, body measurements, and patterns the app has noticed in your own data — always described as a correlation, never a cause.

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Logging anything else

Two ways, and they ask different questions because they know different things.

Start activity — pick what you are doing from a searchable list and the clock runs. Time and strain both count from the moment you press start until you press stop, with laps if you want them. How hard it was is asked *at the end*, because before you start it is a guess.

Add activity — for something already finished. It asks when it started, when it ended, and what strain it came to. The length works itself out from the two times, and the strain is filled in with the app's own estimate which you can type over if your watch gave you a number.

Forgot to log Saturday? Move back a week with the arrow on the calendar, tap the day, and add it there. The card follows the day you selected, so **Add activity** means that day — and **Back to today** returns you.

Settings — the fourth tab, bottom right

Profile	Name, age, height, weight
Training	Equipment, sport, goals, schedule, injuries, and Pause training for a holiday
Sound & alerts	The rest timer, its tones, and being told when it ends while the screen is off

Cycle	Optional menstrual cycle tracking — off unless you turn it on
Wearables	Your device, and importing its data
Data	Backup, restore, delete imported data , and erase everything
Appearance	Light, dark, or follow your phone
About	Version number, the walkthrough, and a diagnostics button for bug reports

IMPORTANT

Your data, and the one thing to remember

Everything you enter lives in your browser, on your phone. There is no account, no server and nothing to sign into — and no way for anyone else, including me, to see any of it. If two people open the same link they each get an empty app, not each other's data.

If you import a wearable export

You export your own data from WHOOP, Garmin, Oura or similar and pick the files yourself. Baseline is **not connected to any of those services** — no account, no password, no integration. It reads the file you chose, in your browser.

What it keeps	The daily figures: recovery, HRV, resting heart rate, sleep, strain, and your workouts
What it never keeps	The file itself, and the free-text notes in a journal export
Where it goes	Your browser's storage, on that device
What is uploaded	Nothing
How to remove it	Settings → Data → Delete imported data , which tells you exactly what it removed

Settings → Data → Erase all data removes everything on the device instead, and starts the app over. One thing worth knowing: Baseline has no passcode of its own, so anyone who can unlock your phone can open it.

That also means a backup is the only copy that exists. If you clear your browser data, lose the phone, or delete the app, it is gone. There is nowhere to restore it from.

So: back it up

Settings → Data → Backup saves one file with everything in it. **Restore** reads it back, including onto a new phone. It takes five seconds. Worth doing every few weeks and before changing phones.

If something looks wrong

- 1 Close the app completely and reopen it.**
Not minimise — close it, then open it again. Twice, if a new version has just been released.
- 2 Check the version.**
It is at the bottom of the Settings screen.
- 3 Send me the diagnostics.**
Settings → About → Copy diagnostics
puts device, browser and storage details on your clipboard, plus counts of how much you have logged. It never includes anything you typed. Paste it into a message along with what you were doing.

Common things

“It says storage is not working.” Add it to your Home Screen (page 3) and open it from there. Private browsing windows also block storage.

“My data disappeared.” Almost always because it was used as a browser tab on an iPhone and iOS cleared it. Home Screen plus a backup prevents this.

Baseline is not a medical device. It does not diagnose anything. Persistent pain, unusual symptoms or readings that worry you belong with a qualified healthcare professional, separately from any training decision.